from his hosts, would not eat any of the dainties which they set before him; so, the old people began to get cross, and, putting a rope around the dog's neck, led him out into the garden. But it was all in vain; he let them lead him where they might, not a sound would the dog utter. He had no "bow-wow" for them. At last, however, the dog stopped at a certain spot, and began to sniff. So, thinking that this must surely be the lucky place, they dug, and found nothing but a quantity of dirt and nasty offal, over which they had to hold their noses. Furious at being disappointed, the wicked old couple seized the dog, and killed him.

When the good old man saw that the dog, whom he had lent, did not come home, he went next door to ask what had become of him; and the wicked old man answered that he had killed the dog and buried him at the root of a pine-tree; so the good old fellow, with a heavy heart, went to the spot, and having set out a tray with delicious food, he burnt incense, and adorned the grave with flowers, as he shed tears over his lost pet.

That night, when the good old man was fast asleep in bed, the dog appeared to him, and, after thanking him for all his kindness, said "Cause the pine-tree, under which I am buried, to be cut down and made into a mortar, and use it, thinking of it as if it were myself."

The old man did as the dog had told him to do, and made a mortar out of the wood of the pine-tree; but when he ground his rice in it, each grain of rice turned into some rich treasure. When the wicked old couple saw this, they came to borrow the mortar; but no sooner did they try to use it, all their rice turned into filth; so, in a fit of rage, they broke the mortar and burnt it. But the

DO YOU KNOW?



Dogs were domesticated from wolves 15,000 years ago. New evidence suggests that dogs were first domesticated in East Asia, possibly China. Over time, hundreds of breeds with a great degree of variation have come into being.



9th English Unit 1 Supplementary Pages 022-027.indd 23 28-11-2022 17:20:41